ACADEMIC HUB • UNIVERSITY DEGREE EXAM PREPARATION SERIES

ENGLISH LANGUAGE SKILLS — MCQ QUESTION BANK

Complete Course (Modules 1–4) • 13 Chapters • 121 MCQs with Verified Answer Keys

Answer Edition • Verified Correct Answers Highlighted in Bold Green with Left Checkmark

Module 1 • Martin Luther King Jr. - 'I Have a Dream' Speech

1. Where did Martin Luther King Jr. deliver the 'I Have a Dream' speech?

A. Montgomery, Alabama
✓ **B. Washington, D.C.**
C. Atlanta, Georgia
D. Chicago, Illinois

2. What major theme does King emphasize in his 'dream'?

A. Economic prosperity for all Americans
B. A world without any political conflict
✓ **C. Racial equality and harmony**
D. The expansion of American territory

3. Which rhetorical device is most famously used throughout the speech?

A. Irony
✓ **B. Repetition**
C. Hyperbole
D. Alliteration

4. King refers to the Declaration of Independence to emphasize which idea?

A. America should become a monarchy
B. All citizens must follow strict laws
✓ **C. The promise of equal rights for all**
D. The need for more economic reforms

5. According to the speech, what should people be judged by?

A. Their wealth
B. Their education level
✓ **C. The content of their character**
D. Their political views

6. What is the primary effect of King's use of 'we' throughout the speech?

A. To highlight King's authority as a leader
B. To reduce the seriousness of the occasion
✓ **C. To create a sense of unity and inclusion**
D. To criticize the audience

7. Which historical document or speech is referenced by King when he opens with 'Five score years ago'?

A. Thomas Paine's Common Sense
✓ **B. Abraham Lincoln's Gettysburg Address**
C. George Washington's Farewell Address
D. Franklin Roosevelt's Inaugural Address

8. Which literary or rhetorical device is used when King refers to another historical text or speech?

A. Hyperbole
B. Irony
✓ **C. Intertextuality**
D. Personification

9. Why does King repeat the phrase 'one hundred years later' several times in the speech?

A. To provide statistical accuracy
B. To slow down the speech for clarity
✓ **C. To emphasize the long delay in achieving justice and freedom**
D. To praise historical progress

10. In the check or promissory note metaphor, what does the 'bad check' refer to?

A. Economic failure of the government
B. Corruption in the federal banking systems
✓ **C. America's failure to deliver guaranteed constitutional rights to citizens of colour**
D. Individual financial struggles among citizens

11. Which rhetorical appeal is primarily used when King evokes deep emotions such as injustice, empathy, and hope?

A. Ethos
✓ **B. Pathos**
C. Logos
D. Allegory

12. What literary device is exemplified by the repetition of a phrase at the beginning of successive clauses (such as 'I have a dream')?

A. Metaphor
✓ **B. Anaphora**
C. Alliteration
D. Oxymoron

13. What does King advocate when confronting injustice and oppression?

A. Using stronger weapons and physical retaliation
B. Avoiding all protest and remaining passive
✓ **C. Responding with nonviolence, dignity, and moral strength**
D. Seeking foreign international intervention

14. The speech mainly inspires which feeling in listeners and participants of the civil rights movement?

A. Fear
B. Cynicism
✓ **C. Hope**
D. Indifference

15. Toward the end of the address, King urges his audience:

A. To end the movement immediately
B. To avoid national attention and media scrutiny
✓ **C. To continue organized, relentless, nonviolent action across their home states**
D. To return to normal life and accept existing conditions

Module 1 • Leonard Cohen - 'Anthem'

16. According to the poem, what instruction is heard at the break of day that encourages renewal and resilience?

A. Focus only on what is yet to be.
✓ **B. Start again, and do not dwell on the past or future.**
C. Ring the bells that still can ring, ignoring the past.
D. Fight the wars that will be fought again.

17. What specific critique is offered regarding the 'holy dove', often symbolising peace or innocence?

A. It is often forgotten when the wars are fought.
B. It sings to announce the need to start again.
✓ **C. It is continually caught, bought, and sold, confirming it is 'never free'.**
D. It represents the perfect offering that must be forgotten.

18. The speaker rejects complicity with the 'lawless crowd' and highlights the hypocrisy of the powerful by noting that the 'killers in high places' are doing what action?

A. Summoning a thundercloud.
B. Running away from the battle.
✓ **C. Saying their prayers out loud.**
D. Adding up the parts to find the sum.

19. What metaphorical element is identified as the necessary channel for 'the light' to enter, reflecting the central theme of grace through imperfection?

A. The ringing of the bells that still can ring.
B. The birth betrayed or the marriage spent.
✓ **C. A crack, a crack in everything.**
D. The finding of a drum for the march.

20. The poem states that 'Every heart, every heart / To love will come.' However, how is the arrival of this love characterised, indicating a sense of vulnerability?

A. Like a perfect offering.
B. Like a lawless crowd.
C. Like a thundercloud.
✓ **D. But like a refugee.**

21. Leonard Cohen's 'Anthem' is often interpreted as a call for:

A. Violent political revolution
✓ **B. Acceptance of human flaws, vulnerability, and imperfections**
C. Radical economic reform
D. Escaping reality and ignoring the world

22. In 'Anthem', Cohen mentions 'the bells', which can be interpreted as a metaphor for:

A. War, violence, and conflict
B. Superficial joy and temporary celebration
C. Rigid tradition and blind routine
✓ **D. Change, spiritual awakening, and hope**

23. Leonard Cohen's 'Anthem' encourages listeners to:

A. Strive for flawless perfection in all things
✓ **B. Embrace imperfection as an inevitable and beautiful part of life**
C. Ignore the world's problems completely
D. Seek material wealth and prestige above all else

24. What kind of text is 'Anthem' in the course listening module?

A. A political speech
B. A short story narrative
✓ **C. A song with poetic lyrics**
D. A newspaper editorial

25. What message do the birds give in the first stanza of 'Anthem'?

A. Remember and lament the past
B. Fear what the future holds
✓ **C. Start again and live fully in the present**
D. Wait for ideal conditions before acting

26. In the third stanza of 'Anthem', what kind of 'signs' are given to humanity?

A. Miracles and divine blessings
B. Messages from heavenly angels
✓ **C. Evidence of social and moral decay**
D. Triumphant scientific breakthroughs

27. In the fifth stanza, what does 'You can add up the parts, but you won't have the sum' suggest?

A. Life can be fully calculated through formal logic
✓ **B. Life cannot be fully understood or explained purely by mechanical reason**
C. Mathematics is flawed and useless
D. Intellectual inquiry should be completely abandoned

28. The phrase 'forget your perfect offering' advises us to:

A. Cease believing in religion and ethics
B. Wait until conditions are flawless before trying
✓ **C. Let go of the paralyzing pursuit of perfection and contribute what we can**
D. Avoid helping others in distress

Module 1 • Amy Morales Lara - 'Art as Social Work'

29. How does Amy Morales Lara personally define art in the context of her discussion?

A. A skill that requires a formal professional certification
B. A clinical discipline strictly regulated by institutions
✓ **C. A form of creative expression that can help you tell a story**
D. Only specialized elite fields like fine oil painting and classical sculpture

30. According to Amy Morales Lara, what is the primary role of a 'helper' in the context of social work?

A. To rescue someone from their problems and impose definitive solutions
B. To manage bureaucratic caseloads and institutional data
✓ **C. To partner with someone in their own process of self-development and growth**
D. To challenge negative self-narratives through professional music production alone

31. What phrase, spoken by her professor, validated Amy Morales Lara's idea of combining creative arts and social work?

A. "The intersection is not impossible, only requires courage."
✓ **B. "In many ways, many social workers are also frustrated artists."**
C. "Art is accessible to everyone, regardless of skill level."
D. "You must lean into the principles of compassion, empathy, and curiosity."

32. Amy Morales Lara notes that art is present in advocacy. What specific example does she cite to show how creative people use art in advocacy?

A. Creating commercial digital advertisements for social campaigns
B. Organizing corporate charity galas
✓ **C. Utilizing beautiful images and inspiring words on picket signs during protests**
D. Implementing pharmaceutical therapy for clinical depression

33. Amy Morales Lara highlights that the Bronx had a meaningful art renaissance. Name any two cultural developments she mentions that were cultivated in the Bronx:

A. Abstract painting and modern minimalist poetry
B. Classical symphony and opera
✓ **C. Hip-hop and salsa**
D. Documentary cinema and traditional Broadway theater

34. When encouraging the audience to enter an art space, what key quality does Amy Morales Lara explicitly state is NOT the goal?

A. Courageousness
B. Openness
C. Bravery
✓ **D. Perfection**

35. In 'Art as Social Work', Amy Morales Lara emphasizes the role of creative art in:

A. Generating commercial profit for galleries
B. Providing passive entertainment for audiences
✓ **C. Facilitating emotional healing, empowerment, and liberation**
D. Promoting partisan political propaganda

36. How does Amy Morales Lara view the intersection of art and social work?

A. As two unrelated, conflicting fields
B. As a superficial way to monetize creative hobbies
✓ **C. As a powerful tool for community building and emotional support**
D. As a replacement for all conventional healthcare

37. How does Amy begin her TED Talk?

A. By listing her academic awards and publications
✓ **B. By admitting that she felt lost and uncertain about her direction in life**
C. By quoting complex social welfare statistics
D. By performing an instrumental violin solo

38. What two main questions does Amy ask herself at the start of her journey?
A. How to earn maximum wealth and gain public fame
B. Who to marry and where to buy property
✓ **C. Who she wants to become and what she wants to do with her life**
D. How to graduate early with highest honours

39. Who famously inspired Amy's foundational concept of being a 'helper'?
A. Her undergraduate dean
B. A famous pop musician
✓ **C. Mr. Rogers**
D. Her high school guidance counselor

40. What central question drives Amy's TED Talk presentation?
A. How to achieve commercial success as a full-time musician
B. How to relocate away from her hometown in the Bronx
✓ **C. How to combine the compassion of social work with the power of creative arts**
D. How to secure funding for non-profit foundations

41. How does Amy define the professional discipline of social work?
A. A commercial business enterprise
✓ **B. A practice-based discipline and profession promoting social change, problem-solving, and empowerment**
C. An academic philosophy detached from community intervention
D. A political party apparatus

42. How did songwriting and music help Amy on a personal level during difficult times?
A. It brought immediate celebrity status and wealth
✓ **B. It helped her process trauma and challenge negative self-narratives**
C. It allowed her to avoid studying for college exams
D. It taught her formal legal defense strategies

43. What empowering final message does Amy leave the audience with?
A. Everyone must leave their career to become a fine artist
B. Only certified social workers have the capacity to help people
✓ **C. Compassion, empathy, and curiosity allow all of us to be helpers in our communities**
D. True success means never experiencing doubt or feeling lost

Module 1 • Speaking Skills & Oral Communication

44. Speaking skills primarily refer to the ability to:
A. Describe macroeconomic fluctuations
B. Speak loudly and assertively before an audience
✓ **C. Express ideas clearly, fluently, and effectively through spoken language**
D. Memorize extensive lists of obscure vocabulary

45. Which of the following practices helps most in improving English pronunciation?
A. Writing long essays without reading them aloud
✓ **B. Active listening and imitating proficient, clear speakers**
C. Memorizing abstract grammatical formulae
D. Silent speed-reading without articulation

46. What does fluency in oral communication mean?
A. Using sophisticated, complex vocabulary at all times
B. Speaking without making a single grammatical error
✓ **C. Speaking smoothly and easily with natural pace and minimal hesitation**
D. Speaking as rapidly as possible

47. Which factor ensures that the tone, register, and vocabulary chosen match the social situation and audience?
A. Vocabulary size
B. Accent precision
✓ **C. Appropriateness (Sociolinguistic competence)**
D. Vocal volume

48. Organising thoughts before speaking mainly helps a speaker to:
A. Increase speaking speed beyond normal tempo
B. Intimidate the listeners with complex syntax
✓ **C. Provide clarity, coherence, and logical flow of ideas**
D. Avoid every minor phonetic slip

Module 2 • George Carlin - 'Soft Language'

49. What is the central theme of George Carlin's monologue 'Soft Language'?
A. The importance of learning foreign vocabulary
B. The grammatical evolution of Old English
✓ **C. The pervasive use of euphemisms to conceal harsh realities**
D. The technical development of modern broadcast comedy

50. According to Carlin, why do people and institutions resort to soft language?
A. To ensure communication is strictly accurate
✓ **B. To make painful or disturbing reality easier to face and conceal truth**
C. To improve linguistic rhythm and pronunciation
D. To prolong the duration of political discussions

51. What was the direct, visceral term used during World War I to describe severe psychological trauma experienced by soldiers?
A. Battle Fatigue
B. Operational Exhaustion
C. Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder
✓ **D. Shell Shock**

52. Which sanitized term replaced 'Shell Shock' during World War II?
A. Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder
✓ **B. Battle Fatigue**
C. Operational Exhaustion
D. Combat Disorder

53. According to Carlin, what happened to the clinical term describing combat trauma over generations?
A. It became simpler, more emotional, and shorter
B. It was completely abandoned by the military
✓ **C. It became progressively longer, more technical, and detached from human suffering**
D. It remained unchanged since the American Civil War

54. What does Carlin suggest about euphemistic language in everyday life?
A. It makes communication clear and honest
B. It enhances genuine emotional connection
✓ **C. It robs language of life and hides uncomfortable truths behind sterile jargon**
D. It prevents misunderstandings among foreign speakers

55. Which literary technique is most prominent throughout Carlin's stand-up performance?
A. Romantic imagery and pastoral lyricism
✓ **B. Satire, irony, and sharp social commentary**
C. Epic verse narration
D. Allegorical symbolism

56. What broader philosophical message does Carlin convey through his critique?
A. Language has zero tangible influence over human thoughts
B. Comedians should refrain from discussing serious social concerns
✓ **C. The words we use shape how we perceive, rationalize, and accept reality**
D. Bureaucratic jargon is superior to simple speech

Module 2 • Arthur Miller - 'Death of a Salesman'

57. What major historical event significantly influenced Arthur Miller's understanding of economic society and shaped his dramatic works?

A. The First World War
B. The American Civil War
✓ **C. The Great Depression**
D. The Cold War

58. Which play established Arthur Miller's international reputation and won both the Pulitzer Prize and the Tony Award?

A. The Crucible
B. All My Sons
C. A View from the Bridge
✓ **D. Death of a Salesman**

59. Who was the primary personal inspiration for the character of Willy Loman?

A. Arthur Miller's father, Isidore Miller
B. Arthur Miller's older brother, Kermit
✓ **C. Arthur Miller's uncle, Manny Newman**
D. Miller's university drama professor

60. Which core theme is most central to the tragedy of Death of a Salesman?

A. Colonial rivalry and nationalistic fervor
✓ **B. The illusory promises and destructive pressures of the American Dream**
C. Military heroism and battlefield valor
D. Technological optimism and industrial automation

61. Why does Biff lose his childhood admiration and respect for his father, Willy?

A. Willy is demoted and loses his sales commission
B. Willy refuses to lend him money for a sporting goods store
✓ **C. Biff catches Willy having an extramarital affair in a Boston hotel room**
D. Willy forces him to leave high school without graduating

62. What does the surrounding urban transformation of Willy's neighbourhood symbolize in the play?

A. Rising economic equality and civic pride
B. The triumph of democratic urban planning
✓ **C. The claustrophobic loss of personal freedom, security, and connection to nature**
D. Abundant entrepreneurial opportunities for youth

63. In the opening of the play, what serious problem causes Willy to return home unexpectedly from his sales road trip?

A. His primary business client cancelled the sales agreement
B. His car suffered a catastrophic engine failure on the highway
✓ **C. He suffers mental exhaustion, loses driving concentration, and repeatedly swerves off the road**
D. He receives urgent telegrams concerning a domestic emergency

Module 2 • 'Rip It Out' (Dead Poets Society / Poetry)

64. Who is the charismatic teacher conducting the unorthodox English literature lesson in the 'Rip It Out' scene?

A. Dr. J. Evans Pritchard
B. Mr. McAllister
✓ **C. John Keating**
D. Headmaster Nolan

65. What does Dr. J. Evans Pritchard's essay attempt to do to literary appreciation?

A. Encourage students to write original verses based on emotional experiences
✓ **B. Measure the greatness of poetry mathematically using Cartesian coordinate graphs and formulas**
C. Examine historical biographies of Elizabethan playwrights
D. Translate classic poems into modern conversational English

66. Why does Mr. Keating command his students to physically tear out the introduction of their poetry textbook?

A. Because the publisher had printed typographical errors
B. Because he dislikes American textbooks in favor of British editions
✓ **C. Because he rejects the artificial, mechanical reduction of artistic passion into mathematical formulas**
D. Because the school administration had banned the book

67. According to Mr. Keating, what is the profound reason human beings read and write poetry?

A. To achieve high marks on academic college entrance tests
B. To prepare for pragmatic professions like law, banking, and medicine
✓ **C. Because we are members of the human race, filled with passion, and poetry sustains the human soul**
D. Because rhyming verse is simpler to memorize than prose

68. Which visionary poet does Mr. Keating quote when delivering his powerful speech about the 'powerful play' of life?

A. Lord Byron
B. William Shakespeare
✓ **C. Walt Whitman**
D. Robert Frost

69. What does Mr. Keating mean when he asks his students: 'What will your verse be?'

A. He wants them to recite a poem for their midterm assessment
✓ **B. He challenges them to discover their purpose and make their own unique, meaningful contribution to the world**
C. He demands that every pupil become a published writer
D. He asks them to choose a favourite classical stanza

70. Why is the 'Rip It Out' lesson included in the undergraduate English literature curriculum?

A. To teach destructive behavior toward physical library books
B. To train students in memorizing standard exam summaries
✓ **C. To encourage critical inquiry, deep aesthetic appreciation, and independent thinking**
D. To review the commercial box-office history of Hollywood cinema

71. What fundamental dynamic makes Keating's classroom scene revolutionary within the school?

A. Enforcing stricter disciplinary punishments
✓ **B. Promoting questioning of dogma, free expression, and intellectual autonomy**
C. Replacing literature classes with physical athletics
D. Following traditional rote learning paradigms

72. How is Welton Academy depicted in the film?

A. A progressive, student-led democratic school
✓ **B. A rigid, deeply conservative institution governed by tradition, honour, discipline, and obedience**
C. An informal community arts center
D. A vocational technical college without academic requirements

73. What is Mr. Keating's core critique of traditional, formulaic poetry pedagogy?

A. That students should read poetry strictly for grammar drills
✓ **B. That poetry must be felt, experienced, and tasted rather than mechanically dissected**
C. That metric rhyming schemes are superior to free verse
D. That literature cannot convey philosophical truths

74. In the classroom, the act of tearing out the textbook's introductory essay symbolizes:

A. Disrespect for authors and literature
✓ **B. The decisive rejection of mechanical conformism, rigid dogma, and intellectual fear**
C. Obedience to administrative instructions
D. A simple exercise in classroom humor

Module 3 • W. B. Yeats - 'The Second Coming'

75. "The Second Coming" was written by W. B. Yeats in the immediate aftermath of which global catastrophe?

A. The French Revolution
✓ **B. The First World War**
C. The Second World War
D. The Irish Potato Famine

76. In the opening stanza of the poem, what does the 'falcon' that cannot hear the falconer primarily symbolize?

A. Untamed wild nature
✓ **B. Humanity or human intellect breaking away from moral control and spiritual guidance**
C. The Christian church hierarchy
D. The isolated voice of the poet

77. What terrifying historical reality does the iconic line "Things fall apart; the centre cannot hold" suggest?

A. Society is steadily uniting towards lasting world peace
✓ **B. Civilization is disintegrating into moral chaos, anarchy, and political collapse**
C. Nature is peacefully regenerating after warfare
D. Traditional monarchies are consolidating absolute power

78. In Yeats's esoteric philosophy, the Latin phrase 'Spiritus Mundi' refers to:

A. The physical geography of planet Earth
B. A classical Roman empire legal treaty
✓ **C. The universal collective memory, subconscious, and archetypal reservoir of humanity**
D. A theological heaven inhabited by angels

79. The ominous 'rough beast' slouching towards Bethlehem symbolizes:

A. The gentle, loving return of Jesus Christ
B. A fleeting, harmless political disturbance
✓ **C. The terrifying dawn of a violent, monstrous new historical cycle**
D. The triumph of rational scientific enlightenment

80. Which of the following encapsulates the overarching theme of "The Second Coming"?

A. Romantic idyllic love and aesthetic pastoral beauty
B. Technological optimism and industrial progress
✓ **C. Apocalyptic dread, pervasive violence, moral confusion, and civilizational collapse**
D. The romanticization of heroic battlefield sacrifice

81. The poem concludes with a haunting rhetorical question about the beast slouching towards Bethlehem. What is the psychological effect of this ending?

A. It provides a clear, reassuring roadmap for modern political leaders
B. It celebrates the triumphant dawn of international democracy
✓ **C. It leaves readers with deep dread, ominous suspense, and cosmic uncertainty**
D. It confirms that salvation has already been achieved

Module 3 • James Finn Garner - 'The Frog Prince'

82. James Finn Garner's "The Frog Prince" is a satirical modern parody of the classic fairy tale originally popularized by:

A. Hans Christian Andersen
B. Charles Perrault
✓ **C. The Grimm Brothers**
D. Lewis Carroll

83. In Garner's humorous politically-correct retelling, how is the princess character depicted?

A. As a helpless, naive damsel waiting passively for rescue
✓ **B. As an independent, environmentally-conscious, eco-feminist woman**
C. As a cruel, spoiled monarch obsessed with gold jewels
D. As a magical sorceress controlling the marshland

84. When the princess kisses the frog and breaks the spell, what does the frog transform into?

A. A dashing and chivalrous prince
B. An honorable medieval knight
C. An honest agrarian peasant farmer
✓ **D. A greedy, exploitative corporate real estate developer**

85. Which socio-economic issue is sharply satirized when the transformed frog announces plans to bulldoze the marsh and build condominiums?

A. Feudal agricultural tax policies
✓ **B. Unchecked predatory capitalism and environmental destruction**
C. Religious monastic asceticism
D. International maritime commerce

86. Which prominent literary techniques are employed throughout Garner's Politically Correct Bedtime Stories?

A. Epic verse and heroic myth
✓ **B. Satire, parody, irony, and subversion of fairy-tale tropes**
C. Naturalistic tragedy and melodrama
D. Gothic suspense and horror

87. What is the primary artistic and social objective of Garner's modernized retelling?

A. To preserve archaic medieval folklore without alteration
B. To glorify royal dynastic traditions
✓ **C. To entertain audiences while humorously exposing modern societal hypocrisies and gender stereotypes**
D. To serve as a strict legal commentary on urban zoning laws

Module 3 • Helen Keller - 'Optimism: An Essay'

88. According to Helen Keller in her essay 'Optimism', what is the universal, fundamental desire shared by all human beings?

A. Immense material wealth
B. Universal public fame and adoration
✓ **C. True happiness and inner fulfilment**
D. Political dominance and worldly power

89. According to Helen Keller, where does authentic and enduring happiness originate?

A. From lavish physical luxuries and sensory pleasures
B. From public social hierarchy and titles
✓ **C. From inner spiritual strength, noble hope, and engaging in meaningful work**
D. From living a life completely free of all challenges

90. What pivotal breakthrough transformed Helen Keller's childhood existence from 'darkness and stillness' into 'hope and joy'?

A. Traveling abroad across European nations
✓ **B. Unlocking the power of language and communication through teacher Anne Sullivan**
C. Receiving national literary awards and financial grants
D. Undergoing experimental medical surgeries

91. What does Helen Keller characterize and denounce as 'false optimism'?

A. Believing that education leads to personal growth
✓ **B. Blindly ignoring real human suffering and social injustice while pretending everything is perfect**
C. Diligently working toward long-term moral ideals
D. Maintaining quiet patience during medical illness

92. According to Keller, what profound virtues does facing and overcoming suffering cultivate in humanity?

A. Cynicism, resentment, and isolation
B. Arrogant pride and selfish ambition
✓ **C. Patience, moral courage, resilience, and deep compassion for others**
D. Lifelong helplessness and dependence on charity

93. Which statement accurately reflects Helen Keller's philosophy of work and human effort?

A. Work is solely a burdensome economic chore meant for earning money
B. Only historically monumental achievements possess genuine value
✓ **C. The willingness and desire to engage in creative work is itself an active declaration of optimism**
D. Laborious tasks should be avoided whenever leisure is possible

94. How does Helen Keller define optimism in the concluding section of her essay?

A. As a fleeting mood that vanishes during cloudy days
B. As irrational wishful thinking without empirical backing
✓ **C. As her personal religion, bedrock faith, and guiding philosophy of existence**
D. As a superficial technique for winning corporate success

95. According to Helen Keller, what is definitely NOT the true foundation of optimism?

A. Spiritual faith and resilience
B. Active dedication to assisting others
✓ **C. Superficial material possessions, physical sensory comforts, and luxury**
D. Facing adversity with moral purpose

96. What does Helen Keller mean by asserting that 'the desire and will to work is in itself an expression of optimism'?

A. That physical labor automatically creates high financial profits
✓ **B. That choosing to work demonstrates faith that human effort matters and the future can be shaped**
C. That students should forgo intellectual pursuits for factory jobs
D. That optimism cannot exist outside formal employment

97. According to Keller, why is confronting evil, hardship, and adversity essential for the human spirit?

A. It forces people to surrender their aspirations and become cynical
B. It proves that human beings are fundamentally incapable of finding peace
✓ **C. It tests and fortifies inner character, teaching human beings to truly value goodness and truth**
D. It demonstrates that suffering can never be overcome

98. What does Helen Keller intend by her 'religion of optimism'?

A. A sectarian dogma demanding unquestioned obedience
B. A ritual that denies the existence of physical illness
✓ **C. An abiding faith in human potential, divine benevolence, and the triumph of light over darkness**
D. A political doctrine favoring social isolation

Module 4 • Dr. B.R. Ambedkar - 'Annihilation of Caste'

99. According to Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, the caste system is fundamentally distinct from ordinary socioeconomic specialization because it is not merely a division of labour, but also a:

A. Division of capital and financial resources
B. Division of religious denominations
✓ **C. Division of labourers into compartmentalized, graded hierarchies**
D. Division of regional languages and dialects

100. Why does Dr. Ambedkar sharply criticize the caste system's mechanism for assigning occupations?

A. Because it fosters excessive market competition among workers
✓ **B. Because it predetermines a person's life pursuit based on parental birth rather than individual aptitude and choice**
C. Because it permits complete occupational mobility and deregulation
D. Because it accelerates factory mechanization and industrial output

101. In his historic treatise, what does Ambedkar identify as a primary limitation imposed by caste on the working individual?

A. It forbids travel abroad completely
B. It denies workers the right to join recreational clubs
✓ **C. It prevents individuals from changing occupations as technological and economic circumstances evolve**
D. It prohibits workers from speaking multiple regional languages

102. Ambedkar argues that the hereditary rigidity of caste directly causes economic stagnation and unemployment because it:

A. Discourages the building of modern highways and transport networks
✓ **B. Prevents people from freely taking up productive callings outside their assigned birth caste even when jobs are vacant**
C. Creates excessive corporate monopolies
D. Forces all citizens into overseas migration

103. According to Ambedkar, why do many essential productive occupations in India provoke 'aversion' and reluctance among workers?

A. Because they require extensive academic degrees
B. Because agricultural tools are difficult to purchase
✓ **C. Because society considers them ritually degrading, treating the worker with social stigma and contempt**
D. Because workers prefer working exclusively in urban government offices

104. What is Dr. Ambedkar's final economic assessment of the caste system as an organization of production?

A. It is highly beneficial because it guarantees hereditary occupational stability
B. It is necessary for maintaining traditional moral consensus and social order
✓ **C. It is profoundly harmful because it suppresses natural inclinations, stifles initiative, and damages economic efficiency**
D. It is the ideal economic model for modern democratic industrial economies

105. Why was Dr. Ambedkar's undelivered presidential address for the Jat-Pat-Todak Mandal conference of Lahore (1936) cancelled by the organizers?

A. Dr. Ambedkar was indisposed and unable to travel to Lahore
B. The British colonial government enacted a curfew in Punjab
✓ **C. The orthodox organizers found his uncompromising critique of sacred Hindu scriptures too provocative and demanded unaccepted revisions**
D. The printed manuscript had not been submitted in time for translation

106. According to Ambedkar, caste divides labourers into a hierarchy that is based strictly on:

A. Merit and demonstrated technical craftsmanship
✓ **B. Accident of birth and inherited social lineage**
C. Individual academic exam qualifications
D. Personal democratic election by peers

107. What does Dr. Ambedkar identify as a catastrophic consequence of caste-based occupational assignment on human talent?

A. It generates excessive creative experimentation
B. It ensures the equal distribution of industrial wealth
✓ **C. It restricts individual freedom, smothers latent talent, and forces individuals into careers they despise**
D. It enhances spontaneous cooperation among community groups

108. According to Dr. Ambedkar, the insidious psychological harm inflicted by caste lies in its capacity to:

A. Promote mutual fellowship and democratic civic responsibility
B. Enhance self-respect and pride among marginalized laborers
✓ **C. Instil feelings of inferiority, shame, helplessness, and enduring social stigma in subordinated classes**
D. Strengthen fraternal national cohesion across linguistic boundaries

109. **Ambedkar argues that the caste system cripples economic and social progress primarily because:**

A. It forces workers to learn too many competing trades
B. It incentivizes workers to abandon agriculture entirely
C. It introduces sudden changes into industrial contracts
✓ **D. It rigidly locks generations into hereditary occupations regardless of individual ability or economic need**

Module 4 • Vaikom Muhammad Basheer - 'The World-Renowned Nose'

110. **What is the absurd reason for the humble cook's sudden rise to worldwide fame in Basheer's satirical tale?**

A. He discovers a miraculous cure for infectious disease
B. He delivers a magnificent, revolutionary political speech
✓ **C. His nose begins to grow unusually long, extending past his mouth and chin**
D. He wins an international culinary championship

111. **Which social institution is most sharply satirized by Basheer for sensationally turning the poor cook into a public spectacle?**

A. The educational examination board
✓ **B. The sensationalist commercial media and press**
C. The supreme judiciary
D. The military establishment

112. **What does the cook's extraordinarily long nose primarily symbolize in the story?**

A. Noble physical strength and moral righteousness
✓ **B. Society's hollow obsession with celebrity, irrational spectacle, and mass hype**
C. Scientific curiosity and medical innovation
D. Spiritual asceticism and religious piety

113. **Which of the following characterizations best describes the protagonist cook throughout the events?**

A. Ambitious, highly educated, and politically cunning
B. Greedy, aristocratic, and eager to exploit the masses
✓ **C. Simple, naive, bewildered, and easily exploited by opportunists**
D. Arrogant, tyrannical, and manipulative

114. **How does Basheer mainly critique partisan politics in 'The World-Renowned Nose'?**

A. By portraying party leaders as noble philosophical statesmen
✓ **B. By depicting rival political factions violently exploiting the cook's nose to divide citizens and win power**
C. By proposing constitutional parliamentary reforms
D. By documenting historical voting turnout in provincial elections

115. **Which distinctive literary style is most brilliantly showcased throughout Basheer's masterpiece?**

A. Gloomy gothic tragedy
B. Sentimental romanticism and pastoral melodrama
✓ **C. Playful satire combined with hilarious irony, sharp wit, and purposeful exaggeration**
D. Hardboiled detective noir

Module 4 • 'Cinema Paradiso' - Movie Review

116. **What is the primary idyllic setting of Giuseppe Tornatore's cinematic masterpiece 'Cinema Paradiso'?**

A. A bustling industrial boulevard in central Rome
✓ **B. A small, nostalgic Sicilian village named Giancaldo**
C. An alpine fishing village in northern France
D. A coastal resort town in Mediterranean Spain

117. **What vital role does the cinema projectionist Alfredo play in young Salvatore's (Toto's) life?**

A. He is Toto's strict elementary schoolteacher
B. He is Toto's elder brother
✓ **C. He becomes Toto's wise mentor, guide, and surrogate father figure**
D. He is a wealthy film producer from Rome

118. **According to Kusali Rupasinghe's review, why is 'Cinema Paradiso' widely celebrated as a profound 'love letter to cinema'?**

A. Because it focuses strictly on the technical mechanisms of camera lenses
✓ **B. Because it honors the communal magic, tender nostalgia, and life-shaping power of movie-watching**
C. Because it denounces television as an inferior artistic medium
D. Because it chronicles the commercial box-office statistics of Hollywood studios

119. **In the local village theatre, what comical ritual does the parish priest perform whenever an affectionate kissing scene appears on screen?**

A. He stands up and orders the entire audience to evacuate
B. He applauds enthusiastically with the townspeople
✓ **C. He vigorously rings his bell to order Alfredo to censor and cut the intimate footage**
D. He confiscates the cinema reels permanently

120. **Which of the following qualities of Kusali Rupasinghe's analysis best demonstrates exemplary film review writing?**

A. Disclosing every plot twist and ending surprise without warning
B. Summarizing the plot line-by-line without examining artistic themes or emotional subtext
✓ **C. Weaving personal heartfelt memories with insightful critical analysis while scrupulously avoiding spoilers**
D. Dismissing all emotional resonance as unscientific sentimentality

121. **Which poignant theme is most powerfully conveyed when adult Salvatore returns to Giancaldo following Alfredo's passing?**

A. The triumph of urban industrialization over traditional craft
B. Intense rivalry in corporate commercial film distribution
✓ **C. The bittersweet weight of nostalgia, the passage of time, and the indelible imprint of childhood roots**
D. The political disputes of post-war Italian regional governance